of overcoming the fortifications that we built on our side of the Canal; in the second case, incapable of such an attack as the one described in the warning documents. We have probably been healed of this disastrous sense of superiority in regard to our neighbors.

Notwithstanding this overall bleak forecast, there are segments within Israeli society that inspire confidence and hope. I became more aware of these bright spots as I heard details from visitors, mainly over the last few weeks. This was indeed a chapter over which I had no clear information previously and which could be summed up as follows. What did actually function on October 7, and during the days and weeks that followed, when many state agencies and mainly the government itself were paralyzed? Who brought help where it was most needed, and saved people in many cases? Those segments of civil society and the networks of volunteers they set up during the demonstrations of the preceding months against the government's attempts to overthrow the country's legal system. These same networks went into action on "Black Saturday," sending help to those people trapped in the villages and kibbutzim on the Gaza border, literally fighting in places that saw no other armed forces, taking care of inhabitants who needed it most and helping them in the most diverse ways. These are the unsung heroes of Israel in its darkest days, and they will possibly set the country on its feet again.

Monday, December 4

The IDF is near Khan Yunis. The war goes on and the population of southern Gaza is its most immediate victim. As today's *Haaretz* reminded those readers who needed reminding, Secretary of State Blinken warned us that military operations in the South of the enclave should not lead to the scale of civilian deaths caused by operations in the North. The US is the only power still supporting Israel. If we disregard Blinken's warning, we